



## PROGRESS REPORT

# Lesotho: progress report, September 2025 – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-26 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

This report asks the same set of questions of every country. The rows below are a fixed frame of indicators, one row each, chosen in advance and covering all thirty-eight subjects the repository tracks — so what appears here is decided by the frame and not by whichever records happened to accumulate. Each row says what happened on that indicator during the period, with every claim linked to the source it rests on.

Where a row reads *No evidence*, the repository holds nothing on that indicator. **That is a statement about this repository, not about the country** — it does not mean nothing exists, only that nothing has been collected here yet. The rows that carry evidence say what it is; the rows that do not are left to speak for themselves.

*The period is 2025-09-01 to 2026-09-26.*

**Progress values.** *Movement* — some form of progress, however minor, has been recorded. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the repository holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the repository holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Movement, regulations still pending*.

## Governance

| TOPIC                          | INDICATOR                              | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | PROGRESS  |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Strategies, plans and policies | <b>Digital transformation strategy</b> | The <a href="#">National Digital Transformation Strategy: Agenda 2030</a> has been in force unamended since 2024, with no review or successor on file.<br><br>The strategy was launched in 2024 and stands unamended (strategy). No mid-term review, progress report, costing or delivery schedule under it has been published, so the repository holds the instrument and no account of what it has moved. | NO CHANGE |
| Strategies, plans and policies | <b>ICT strategy</b>                    | The <a href="#">National Digital Policy 2024</a> remains in force and unamended, sitting alongside the transformation strategy issued the same year.<br><br>The policy was issued in 2024 and is recorded as in force, unamended (policy).<br>Nothing on file records an implementation plan, a regulator instruction issued under it, or any assessment of its effect.                                     | NO CHANGE |

| TOPIC                          | INDICATOR                                        | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | PROGRESS                                                          |
|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Strategies, plans and policies | <b>Broadband strategy</b>                        | <p>A <a href="#">Broadband Infrastructure Sharing Policy</a> was signed by the communications minister in June 2026, with no implementation instrument on record.</p> <p>The minister signed the policy on 12 June 2026, one of three digital policies signed together (signing). The text itself is not held, so its obligations on licensees cannot be stated.</p> <p>The 2025/26 budget speech had recorded the drafts as validated, and no regulator guidance under the signed policy has been published since (budget speech).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | MOVEMENT                                                          |
| Strategies, plans and policies | <b>Data storage / cloud strategy</b>             | <p>A <a href="#">national data-centre implementation roadmap</a> went into drafting at a six-ministry Maseru workshop in August 2026; no text yet exists.</p> <p>The five-day workshop opened on 17 August 2026, organised by the communications ministry with the United Nations in Lesotho and coordinated by the UN Office for Digital and Emerging Technologies (workshop).</p> <p>The roadmap covers data governance, skills, compute, energy, cooling, financing and implementation choices, and builds on the artificial-intelligence, data-management and broadband policies validated in draft in January 2025 (roadmap). No publication date, custodian or cost is stated, and its relationship to the separately recorded Kobong data centre is not stated.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | MOVEMENT                                                          |
| Strategies, plans and policies | <b>Data interoperability framework / roadmap</b> | <p>An <a href="#">enterprise architecture and interoperability framework</a> was <a href="#">commissioned in 2024</a>; neither it nor a roadmap has been published.</p> <p>2024-07-22 — terms of reference commissioned the government enterprise architecture and e-government interoperability framework.</p> <p>2025-08-26 — the communications ministry opened a two-day workshop to develop a digital public infrastructure framework.</p> <p>Two years on from the commission, no framework document, roadmap or timetable is on the record, and the repository carries nothing on what the architecture covers.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | MOVEMENT<br>commissioned and unpublished                          |
| Strategies, plans and policies | <b>AI strategy</b>                               | <p>A <a href="#">National AI Policy</a> was signed in June 2026 and a separate <a href="#">National AI Strategy</a> went into drafting in August; neither text is held.</p> <p>The government and the United Nations ran a five-day high-level policy and capacity-building workshop on a national artificial-intelligence strategy and a data centre blueprint (workshop). No strategy text is held.</p> <p>The policy was signed by the communications minister on 12 June 2026, covering responsible artificial intelligence in health, education and public administration (signing, account). Its text is not held, so its scope and commitments cannot be stated.</p> <p>A distinct National AI Strategy was being drafted at a Maseru workshop that opened on 17 August 2026, intended as the framework for deployment; the deputy prime minister's keynote asked for capability assessment, safeguards, infrastructure, policy and human capacity to be settled before investment is widened (strategy).</p> | MOVEMENT                                                          |
| Strategies, plans and policies | <b>Data localisation policies</b>                | <p>No localisation or residency rule is held; <a href="#">section 52 of the Data Protection Act</a> governs cross-border transfer instead.</p> <p>2012-02-22 — the Act's section 52 governs cross-border transfer of personal information, the closest enacted instrument to a residency rule.</p> <p>2025-10-14 — a validation workshop aligned the draft data management policy with the African Union data policy framework.</p> <p>2026-02-20 — the ministry's ICT director said the policy was on the verge of being finalised, four months before it was signed.</p> <p>No rule requiring government or personal data to be held in Lesotho is on the record.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | MOVEMENT<br>on a general data policy rather than a residency rule |

| TOPIC                          | INDICATOR                          | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | PROGRESS  |
|--------------------------------|------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Strategies, plans and policies | <b>Data governance policy</b>      | <p>A <a href="#">Data Management Policy</a> was signed in June 2026 as a privacy, security and ethical-use framework, and a <a href="#">data value blueprint</a> is in drafting.</p> <p>The minister signed the Data Management Policy on 12 June 2026 (signing), and its text is not held.</p> <p>Drafting of a National Data Value Creation Blueprint opened at a first national consultative workshop on 14 and 15 July 2026, with no text yet in existence (workshop). The country's membership of the Smart Africa programme behind it rests on a spokesperson's remarks carried by the government news agency.</p> <p>2026-09 – the draft Data Value Creation Blueprint was validated at a national workshop in Maseru with Smart Africa and GIZ, the first country to validate one; its diagnostic calls the data landscape emerging but fragmented. It is not yet adopted and its text is not published.</p> | MOVEMENT  |
| Strategies, plans and policies | <b>Open data policy</b>            | <p>The government's own digital policy records that <a href="#">open government data legislation has yet to be promulgated</a>.</p> <p>2024-12-30 – the National Digital Policy states Lesotho has yet to promulgate legislation on open government data, the most current statement the repository holds.</p> <p>2025-09-24 – the Prime Minister told a leaders' symposium that Lesotho had adopted a national digital framework and was piloting digital public infrastructure, working with regional and European partners to validate a data governance policy.</p> <p>The absence was searched on 31 August 2026: no portal, no policy, no dataset inventory. A data management policy was signed in June 2026 and is not an open-data instrument.</p>                                                                                                                                                          | NO CHANGE |
| Legislation and regulation     | <b>Data protection legislation</b> | <p>The <a href="#">Data Protection Act 2011</a> remains in force and unamended, on the most recent account held, dated March 2026.</p> <p>The Act has been in force since 2011 and was recorded as unamended as at 23 March 2026 (review).</p> <p>No amendment, regulation or commencement instrument has been published since, and the repository holds no enforcement action, complaint count or guidance issued under it.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | NO CHANGE |
| Legislation and regulation     | <b>Cybersecurity legislation</b>   | <p>The Computer Crime and Cybersecurity Bill was split; the <a href="#">Cybercrime Bill</a> awaits National Assembly approval and the <a href="#">Cybersecurity Bill 2026</a> went to a second consultation in September 2026.</p> <p>Both bills were reported on 29 July 2026 as awaiting National Assembly approval, on no published timetable (forum, account).</p> <p>The Cybersecurity Bill is intended to build the institutions protecting critical digital infrastructure, which is the statute the interim response team now operating was set up ahead of (interim body). No text of either bill is held.</p> <p>The Cybersecurity Bill 2026 was circulated in draft in August 2026 and taken to a second stakeholder consultation on 23 September, proposing a two-tier regulatory regime and the registration of cybersecurity professionals (consultation).</p>                                         | MOVEMENT  |

| TOPIC                      | INDICATOR                                         | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | PROGRESS                                                      |
|----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Legislation and regulation | <b>Legislation covering digital id</b>            | <p>The <a href="#">National Identity Cards Act 2011</a> is the founding statute; an electoral Bill now ties voter registration to the identity number.</p> <p>2011-03-21 — Act 9 of 2011 establishes the National Identity Register and the identity-card regime, commenced in 2013.</p> <p>2026-06-04 — the Senate adopted its legislation committee's report on the electoral amendment Bill, which ties voter registration and verification to the national identity number.</p> <p>2026-06-29 — the home affairs ministry opened a workshop on a systems architecture and modernisation framework, setting out the legal and institutional implications of the reforms proposed.</p> <p>No amendment to the 2011 Act is before Parliament.</p> <p>2022-06-24 — regulations requiring every SIM card to be registered came into operation; the regulator let the June 2023 deadline pass while it cleaned the data and set 31 January 2024 as the last day before unregistered cards are cut off. The notice does not say which identity document registration requires.</p> | MOVEMENT                                                      |
| Legislation and regulation | <b>Digital payments legislation</b>               | <p>The <a href="#">Payment System Bill</a> reached second reading in May 2026, to replace the 2014 Act and license fintech providers.</p> <p>2014-09-12 — the Payment Systems Act governs payment systems and instruments, electronic money and cards among them.</p> <p>2025-11-17 — the financial sector strategy sets strengthening the payments system and access to digital financial services as cross-cutting priorities.</p> <p>2026-05-05 — the finance minister moved the Payment System Bill to second reading, to repeal and replace the 2014 Act and license fintech payment providers.</p> <p>No enactment date is on the record.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | MOVEMENT                                                      |
| Legislation and regulation | <b>Legislation enabling data interoperability</b> | <p>No dedicated interoperability statute exists; the <a href="#">VAT e-invoicing regulations</a> are the binding data-exchange rule the repository holds.</p> <p>2012-02-22 — the Data Protection Act is the closest enacted instrument bearing on lawful sharing of personal government data.</p> <p>2026-03-27 — Legal Notice 25 of 2026 requires system-to-system electronic transmission of VAT transaction data, a binding interoperability rule confined to one revenue stream.</p> <p>2025-08-26 — a workshop opened to develop a digital public infrastructure framework.</p> <p>No statute enabling data exchange across government generally is held.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | MOVEMENT<br>on a tax regulation rather than a general statute |
| Legislation and regulation | <b>AI legislation / regulations</b>               | <p>The government names the <a href="#">AI Policy of 2025</a> as its governance foundation; no AI Act or regulation exists.</p> <p>2026-02-20 — the ministry's ICT director reported the national AI policy successfully approved.</p> <p>2026-07-07 — the Deputy Prime Minister told the UN global dialogue that the policy is the country's AI governance foundation.</p> <p>2026-07-20 — Lesotho signed the founding agreement of a world AI cooperation organisation in Shanghai, an international commitment ahead of any domestic law.</p> <p>The absence was searched on 31 August 2026. No Bill, no regulations, and no announced timetable for either.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | NO CHANGE<br>a policy with no statute behind it               |
| Legislation and regulation | <b>E-commerce legislation</b>                     | <p>The <a href="#">Electronic Transactions and Electronic Communications Bill</a> remains pending promulgation; the movement was in adjacent law.</p> <p>2024-12-30 — the National Digital Policy records the 2022 Bill as still pending promulgation.</p> <p>2026-03-27 — electronic invoicing was made mandatory for VAT transactions, a direct digital-commerce compliance rule made while the general statute waits.</p> <p>2026-05-05 — the Payment System Bill reached second reading.</p> <p>Four years after it was drafted, Lesotho still has no statute recognising electronic transactions generally.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | NO CHANGE<br>the Bill still pending                           |

| TOPIC                      | INDICATOR                                 | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | PROGRESS                                                                                                              |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Legislation and regulation | <b>Statistics legislation</b>             | <p>A <a href="#">fourth Statistics Bill</a> is expected to be enacted before the end of 2026, replacing a statute from 2001.</p> <p>2001 – Act 8 of 2001 establishes the Bureau of Statistics and the national statistical system.</p> <p>2025-12-12 – a regional peer review recorded a fourth Statistics Bill in drafting and recommended modernising the 2001 Act.</p> <p>2026-06-27 – bureau officials described the Bill's content and expected enactment before the end of 2026.</p> <p>The Bill text is not held.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | MOVEMENT                                                                                                              |
| Legislation and regulation | <b>Access to information legislation</b>  | <p>A 2021 capacity assessment found <a href="#">no access-to-information legislation in force</a>, and nothing since records one being enacted.</p> <p>The assessment carried out for the Millennium Challenge Corporation and the Lesotho Millennium Development Agency found no access-to-information statute in force in September 2021 (assessment).</p> <p>No bill, draft or commitment to one has appeared in the repository in the five years since, so the absence is a searched one at that date and an unexamined one after it.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | NO CHANGE                                                                                                             |
| Data protection            | <b>Data protection authority</b>          | <p>The Data Protection Commission is <a href="#">provided for by the 2011 Act</a> but no commissioner had been appointed as at March 2026.</p> <p>The commission exists in law and not in fact: the 2011 Act provides for it, and the most recent account held records no commissioner appointed as at 23 March 2026 (review).</p> <p>Fifteen years after the statute, the repository holds no appointment, no budget line, no staff and no supervisory decision from it.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | NO CHANGE                                                                                                             |
| Data protection            | <b>National data protection readiness</b> | <p>A <a href="#">US\$364m health agreement</a> with the United States carries data-sharing agreements that have not been published, after a brief release was withdrawn.</p> <p>The agreement was signed in December 2025 and stated at US\$364m (complaint). The State Department published a subset of the memoranda in March 2026 and then removed public access, and the related data-sharing agreements have not been published.</p> <p>Lesotho is one of sixteen countries named in a freedom-of-information suit filed on 2 April 2026 that remains unresolved, and African governments had already pushed back on the health deals over data and power (reporting).</p> <p>The ICT ministry reported in September 2026 that DPI Safeguards for Children, developed with UNICEF, are being piloted with the national university across five ministries; no text or pilot result is published.</p> | REGRESSED<br>the data-sharing instrument behind a bilateral health agreement was briefly published and then withdrawn |
| Regional collaboration     | <b>Regional policy collaboration</b>      | <p>Lesotho joined the <a href="#">50-in-5 digital public infrastructure campaign</a> as its fourteenth member in May 2024, and no milestone has been reported since.</p> <p>The country joined in May 2024 as the fourteenth member, with civil registration and its integration with digital public infrastructure named as the commitment (joining, profile).</p> <p>No milestone, review or output under the campaign has been reported for the country in the two years since.</p> <p>2026-09-09 - a review with South Africa agreed to accelerate smart one-stop border posts at Maseru and Ficksburg.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | MOVEMENT                                                                                                              |

| TOPIC                  | INDICATOR                                  | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | PROGRESS                                                                                                            |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Regional collaboration | <b>Regional legal harmonisation</b>        | <p>The <a href="#">African Union data protection convention</a> was signed in November 2023 and not ratified, and a <a href="#">data policy framework readiness workshop</a> in July 2025 has no output on file.</p> <p>AUDA-NEPAD convened a readiness workshop from 28 to 31 July 2025 on domesticating the framework (workshop).</p> <p>No readiness assessment, legislative review or instrument has followed it into the repository, so the domestication is recorded as convened and not as done.</p> <p>2023-11-30 – Lesotho signed the African Union Convention on Cyber Security and Personal Data Protection and had not ratified it on the Union's list of 8 July 2024, a Lesotho law firm reported. No ratification bill is on file.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | NO CHANGE                                                                                                           |
| Regional collaboration | <b>Shared regional infrastructure</b>      | <p>Lesotho is a <a href="#">founding pilot country of the regional settlement system</a> and hosts the <a href="#">regional cyber drill</a>.</p> <p>2023-11-08 – Lesotho is named one of four founding pilot countries of the regional real-time gross settlement system.</p> <p>2025-08-25 – a partnership was announced to build a federated regional identity-verification arrangement, on a validated Lesotho-South Africa pilot.</p> <p>2025-11-04 – Lesotho hosted the sixth regional cyber drill and announced joining the Smart Africa Alliance.</p> <p>A small landlocked economy reaches shared infrastructure it could not build alone; what the repository does not hold is any figure for what Lesotho contributes to or draws from it.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                              | MOVEMENT                                                                                                            |
| Regional collaboration | <b>Cross-border data transfers</b>         | <p>The only cross-border arrangement on file is the <a href="#">health data-sharing instrument</a> with the United States, whose text is withheld.</p> <p>African governments pushed back during 2026 on United States health agreements over data and power, this country's among them (reporting).</p> <p>The data-sharing agreements attached to its own agreement have not been published, and the repository holds no adequacy decision, transfer safeguard or domestic authorisation covering them (complaint).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | NO CHANGE                                                                                                           |
| Standards              | <b>National interoperability standards</b> | <p>A <a href="#">Government Enterprise Architecture and Interoperability Framework</a> has been under development since the 2025/26 budget, with no further detail published.</p> <p>The budget speech recorded the framework as under development, aimed at improving government efficiency and service delivery and at avoiding fragmented and costly infrastructure deployment across government (budget speech).</p> <p>No draft, adoption date, standards register or list of the systems bound by it has been published in the eighteen months since.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | MOVEMENT                                                                                                            |
| Standards              | <b>National quality standards</b>          | <p><a href="#">Quality-of-service rules</a> have been in force since 2023, and the regulator's own testing puts <a href="#">compliance at 75 per cent</a> with speeds far below target.</p> <p>Legal Notice No. 41 of 2023 came into force on 21 April 2023, prescribing minimum quality-of-service standards for voice, data, postal and courier licensees across accessibility, integrity and retainability, with two published schedules of measurable parameters (rules).</p> <p>The two mobile operators reached 75 per cent overall compliance across twelve general parameters in the year to 31 March 2025, missing on disconnection-complaint resolution time and mobile order-completion time (annual report).</p> <p>Drive-testing across three Maseru clusters in November 2025 found mean download speeds of 2.88 to 2.95 Mbps against a 25 Mb/s target, and unsuccessful call ratios of 2.6 to 6.2 per cent against a 2 per cent ceiling (testing).</p> | MIXED<br>quality-of-service rules in force and measured, with two parameters missed and speeds far below the target |

| TOPIC                                           | INDICATOR                                               | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | PROGRESS                                                     |
|-------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Standards                                       | <b>Adoption of international standards</b>              | <p>The <a href="#">standards institution is operational</a> and the identity build runs on an <a href="#">international open-source standard</a>.</p> <p>2020-09-16 — the trade minister declared the standards institution operational, with a standards-development, testing and certification mandate.</p> <p>2025-10-14 — a validation workshop aligned the data management policy with the African Union data policy framework.</p> <p>2026-02-26 — the 2026 work plan continues deployment of an internationally developed open-source digital identity standard.</p> <p>No list of standards adopted, and no conformance regime, is published.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | <b>MOVEMENT</b>                                              |
| Public debate and participation in policymaking | <b>Non-governmental contribution to national policy</b> | <p>A standing <a href="#">National Cybersecurity Forum</a> was constituted in July 2026, spanning government, industry, regulators, banks and telecommunications providers.</p> <p>The forum held its inaugural meeting on 29 July 2026 and is standing rather than convened for an occasion (launch, account).</p> <p>It is the only structured route on file by which bodies outside government contribute to national digital policy, and no terms of reference, membership list or output from it has been published (report).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | <b>MOVEMENT</b>                                              |
| Public debate and participation in policymaking | <b>Open discussion of government policy</b>             | <p><a href="#">Media freedom fell 14.0 points to 48.6 of 100 over 2014-2023</a>, and an <a href="#">allegation of political interference</a> in regulator appointments is denied by the ministry.</p> <p>The outgoing chief licensing officer at the communications authority alleged at a media briefing reported on 22 August 2026 that the communications minister pressed the board to re-advertise the post rather than renew the five-year contract that expired on 31 May 2026, and that the universal service fund's executive secretary was removed in the same way (briefing).</p> <p>The minister stated the ministry has no role in recruiting the authority's managers, and the authority declined to comment. It is an allegation with a ministerial denial and no regulator response, and the repository holds no inquiry into it.</p> <p>2024 — the Ibrahim Index recorded media freedom down 14.0 points over 2014-2023 to 48.6 of 100, digital freedom down 8.6 points to 77.1, and public perception of freedom of speech down 17.7 points to 61.5.</p> | <b>REGRESSED</b><br>on the governance index's freedom scores |

## Finance

| TOPIC                                          | INDICATOR                                                       | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | PROGRESS           |
|------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure | <b>Sustainable domestic financing of digital transformation</b> | <p>The <a href="#">2026/27 appropriation</a> was enacted on 31 March 2026, voting the ICT ministry's head with an M10 million e-government capital line, after <a href="#">M381.1 million</a> for the sector in 2025/26.</p> <p>The budget speech of 19 February 2025 allocated M381.1 million to the sector and named its intended uses: a Government Security Operations Centre, a Government of Lesotho Enterprise Architecture and Interoperability Framework, a completed fibre feasibility study, 17 operational base tower stations and a 96km fibre stretch from Roma to Thaba-Tseka (budget speech).</p> <p>The 2026/27 budget was opened on 18 February 2026 (speech), enacted by the Appropriation (2026/2027) Act on 31 March 2026 (act) and set out in the approved estimates book, which carries an M10 million e-government capital line under the ICT ministry (estimates). No sector total for 2026/27 is held beside the 2025/26 figure, so the two years cannot be compared.</p> | <b>MOVEMENT</b>    |
| Financial sustainability                       | <b>Financial sustainability of digital systems</b>              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | <b>NO EVIDENCE</b> |

| TOPIC                     | INDICATOR                                    | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | PROGRESS |
|---------------------------|----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| MoUs and other agreements | <b>Strategic relationships</b>               | <p><a href="#">Smart Africa</a>, <a href="#">the African Union</a> and <a href="#">the German Embassy</a> were named as supporters of the data blueprint work, with no programme document or amount held.</p> <p>The three were named as supporters at the first blueprint workshop in July 2026 (workshop).</p> <p>No terms of reference, programme document or amount is held for any of them, so the repository records three named backers and nothing that any of them is committed to.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | MOVEMENT |
| New investments           | <b>Mobilisation of non-state finance</b>     | <p><a href="#">Project Kobong</a> is the largest private proposition on file, put by government at M100bn and by the developer at about US\$6.2bn, but it is an investment envelope, not a commitment.</p> <p>The government figure was M98bn in June 2026 and M100bn in August (approval, tribune account); the developer's chief executive states about US\$6.2bn of capital investment, while the developer's own release of 8 June 2026 states no value (release).</p> <p>The memorandum of agreement of 4 June 2026 lets the developer study feasibility and seek funding; it commits no money, and everything turns on feasibility, financing, permitting and definitive agreements (memorandum).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | MOVEMENT |
| New investments           | <b>Development-partner project financing</b> | <p>Partner money carries three named projects: a <a href="#">World Bank US\$12m public sector foundations credit</a>, an <a href="#">African Development Bank e-government phase</a> and a <a href="#">UNICEF learning dashboard</a>.</p> <p>The African Development Bank committed US\$13.95m to the second phase of the eGovernment Infrastructure Project in 2019, with US\$16.5m disbursed and the project ending in 2026 (commitment); a Digital Outreach Studio was launched under it in June 2026 (studio). UNICEF and the Global Partnership for Education announced support on 23 July 2026 for a foundational literacy and numeracy dashboard, with tablets for principals in 300 project schools and solar power in 25 cluster learning spaces (support).</p> <p>2024-01-23 — the World Bank approved a SDR 9.1m (US\$12m) credit for the Public Sector Foundations for Service Delivery Project, closing in March 2028, with US\$5m of it for shared digital government foundations: an interoperability platform, a national computer emergency response team, a government security operations centre and renewed government hosting. No disbursement figure under it is held.</p> | MOVEMENT |

## ICT Infrastructure

| TOPIC        | INDICATOR                 | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | PROGRESS |
|--------------|---------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Connectivity | <b>Mobile penetration</b> | <p>The larger operator reports <a href="#">1.21m customers</a> and <a href="#">85 per cent market share</a>, and the other has <a href="#">149 5G sites</a> on 700MHz.</p> <p>The thirtieth-anniversary account of June 2026 gives 1.21m customers, 85 per cent market share, 422 base stations of which 101 are solar, and coverage of 97 per cent on 2G, 98 per cent on 3G and 96 per cent on 4G (account).</p> <p>A US\$40m phased network upgrade was announced in March 2026 (upgrade), following an upgrade pledged at the group chief executive's visit in August 2025 (visit).</p> <p>The second operator grew its 5G sites from 54 to 149 on 700MHz by June 2025, and no later figure is held (5G, network).</p> | MOVEMENT |

| TOPIC        | INDICATOR                               | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | PROGRESS                                            |
|--------------|-----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Connectivity | <b>Internet usage</b>                   | <p>Internet use <a href="#">rose from 32.5% of individuals in 2016 to 58.4% in 2023</a>; the ministry puts <a href="#">regular use at about 50 per cent against full broadband coverage</a>.</p> <p>The communications ministry stated the two figures at the United Nations Global Dialogue on AI Governance in July 2026 (statement). It measures regular use, a narrower count than the regulator's household survey.</p> <p>The one product launched into that gap is a fixed-mobile convergence service, live since July 2025 with nothing later on record (service).</p> <p>2023 — the regulator's household survey with the Bureau of Statistics found 58.4% of individuals using the internet, up from 32.5% in 2016 and 42.3% in 2019.</p> <p>2024 — the Ibrahim Index scored internet and computers at 22.3 of 100 for 2023, 42nd of 54 African states and 3.3 points above 2014.</p> | <b>MOVEMENT</b>                                     |
| Connectivity | <b>Mobile affordability</b>             | <p>The regulator <a href="#">found against an operator over unnotified airtime restrictions and ordered them reversed</a>; no price series is published.</p> <p>2020-02 — a World Bank diagnostic is the repository's fullest account of digital infrastructure and affordability.</p> <p>2025-10-01 — an operator published promotional bundle terms.</p> <p>2025-12-05 — the regulator found against an operator over airtime restrictions applied without notice and ordered them reversed.</p> <p>No basket price, income share or affordability index for Lesotho is held, which is what this indicator turns on.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | <b>MOVEMENT</b><br>on enforcement rather than price |
| Connectivity | <b>National fibre backbone</b>          | <p>A <a href="#">metropolitan fibre network</a> has a completed feasibility study and no construction reported; a <a href="#">96km Roma to Thaba-Tseka stretch</a> was under way in 2025.</p> <p>The budget speech of February 2025 recorded the feasibility study for the Lesotho Metropolitan Fibre Distribution Network as completed, laying groundwork for high-speed broadband across the major towns, with construction not reported (feasibility).</p> <p>The same speech recorded a 96km fibre stretch from Roma to Thaba-Tseka under way and 17 base tower stations operational (budget speech). Eighteen months on, no completion, route map or capacity figure has been published for either.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                    | <b>MOVEMENT</b>                                     |
| Connectivity | <b>International internet bandwidth</b> | <p>A <a href="#">managed satellite enterprise service</a> launched in August 2026, the first international path not transiting a neighbour.</p> <p>2018-02-13 — the regulator's sector review describes the international gateways and bandwidth pricing structure.</p> <p>2026-07-01 — the regulator's strategic plan makes universal and meaningful connectivity its top theme.</p> <p>2026-08-26 — the incumbent operator launched managed satellite enterprise connectivity.</p> <p>Lesotho is landlocked and every terrestrial route crosses South Africa. No capacity figure in gigabits, and no wholesale price, is published.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | <b>MOVEMENT</b>                                     |
| Connectivity | <b>Internet Exchange Points</b>         | <p>The <a href="#">exchange was relaunched after a revamp in February 2026</a>, with a <a href="#">refreshed registry record in May</a>.</p> <p>2011 — the regulator's annual report covers the exchange's founding period and the regional cable completion.</p> <p>2026-02-02 — the Internet Society chapter relaunched the revamped exchange.</p> <p>2026-05-13 — a refreshed registry record gives a later externally visible snapshot.</p> <p>No peer count, traffic figure or capacity for the exchange is published.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | <b>MOVEMENT</b>                                     |

| TOPIC        | INDICATOR                                              | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | PROGRESS                                                                                                                                         |
|--------------|--------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Connectivity | <b>Satellite broadband licensing and availability</b>  | <p>A <a href="#">ten-year satellite licence</a> was granted in April 2025 over local-shareholding objections, and the <a href="#">service is live</a> through a sole reseller.</p> <p>The communications authority granted a ten-year licence on 14 April 2025, contested over full foreign ownership: the incumbent appealed for local shareholding and a rights group objected (licence, objection). Nothing later on record resolves the objection.</p> <p>The service launched through T-Connect as exclusive reseller on 30 June 2025 (launch, account), and by January 2026 was reported also carried over the incumbent's low-earth-orbit backhaul (backhaul).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | <b>MOVEMENT</b>                                                                                                                                  |
| Data Storage | <b>Local data centre capacity (all providers)</b>      | <p><a href="#">Project Kobong</a> was approved in July 2026 as a green-powered artificial-intelligence data centre at Mokhotlong, with construction targeted for 2029.</p> <p>The project was approved and launched at a ceremony hosted by the United States Embassy on 31 July 2026, on a binding memorandum covering pumped storage and a data centre at Mokhotlong, conditional on feasibility, financing, permitting and definitive agreements (approval, partnership).</p> <p>Construction is targeted for 2029 (account, first data centre). The repository holds no operating commercial data-centre capacity in the country at all, so the whole of this indicator is a project not due to break ground for three years.</p> <p>2026-09-15 — the largest foreign investment the country has recorded is a data centre: a US\$6.2bn hydropower and AI data centre agreement was signed, with a minister holding shares in a named potential local partner. A feasibility study comes first.</p> | <b>MOVEMENT</b>                                                                                                                                  |
| Data Storage | <b>Local data centre capacity (national providers)</b> | <p>The incumbent operator runs <a href="#">two commercial data centres</a>; the state's own hosting is still in build.</p> <p>2026-08-29 — the operator names two facilities, at Maseru West and Lekokoaneng, the strongest current self-description held.</p> <p>2025-08-01 — the regulator opened procurement for disaster-recovery IT equipment.</p> <p>2026-05-07 — the minister raised a high-performance computing upgrade and pitched data-centre investment at the United Nations.</p> <p>2021-10-04 — a contract was awarded to assess the government's three data centres for interoperability.</p> <p>2025-09-26 — a three-year LSL 35.6m contract to replace end-of-life government data-hosting equipment was awarded.</p> <p>No floor space, rack count or power figure is published for any facility in Lesotho.</p>                                                                                                                                                                     | <b>MOVEMENT</b>                                                                                                                                  |
| Data Storage | <b>Off-site backup capacity</b>                        | <p>A <a href="#">business-continuity and hosting contract</a> was awarded in <a href="#">September 2025</a>, while the <a href="#">backup data centre at Mohale's Hoek</a> has no record of going live.</p> <p>The Mohale's Hoek facility was toured near-complete by the communications minister in May 2018, awaiting its power station, and designed as a backup 100km from the finance ministry's Maseru data centre; in October 2021 a contract was awarded to bring it into operation and to integrate the three government data centres. No source confirms it going live.</p> <p>2025-09-26 - the finance ministry awarded a three-year LSL 35.6m contract to replace end-of-life government data-hosting equipment and build a business-continuity framework for the public sector, financed by the World Bank's concessional arm. No recovery objective or second-site arrangement under it is published.</p>                                                                                 | <b>MIXED</b><br>a business-continuity contract was awarded while the backup data centre toured near-complete in 2018 has no record of going live |

| TOPIC              | INDICATOR                                             | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | PROGRESS                                                                                                                    |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Energy             | <b>Sufficient energy and water for data centres</b>   | <p>Generation runs at <b>about 72MW against about 209MW of demand</b>, while <b>Kobong</b> plans at least 1,200MW of pumped storage for its data centre.</p> <p>About 72MW is installed against about 209MW of domestic demand, and 438 of the 970 GWh consumed in 2024 were imported (generation).</p> <p>The Kobong memorandum covers at least 1,200MW of pumped storage alongside a green-powered data centre, conditional on feasibility and financing and with construction targeted for 2029 (approval). No water assessment for the site is held, and no statement connects the new generation to the existing national deficit.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | <div>MIXED</div> <p>a national generation deficit against a dedicated pumped-storage scheme planned for the data centre</p> |
| Energy             | <b>Grid reliability</b>                               | <p>The utility reports <b>more than 99% availability on transmission and around 95% on distribution</b>, held over recent years.</p> <p>2026-08-29 – the electricity corporation states it has maintained availability above 99% on the transmission network and around 95% on distribution for the past years, attributing faults to an ageing network and weather.</p> <p>2026-05-27 – a \$50m credit was approved combining grid expansion with utility-reform technical assistance.</p> <p>2026-03-01 – the first quarterly progress report against the energy compact's reform commitments was published.</p> <p>The availability figures are the utility's own and the repository holds nothing testing them. No outage-duration or interruption-frequency figure is published.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | <div>NO CHANGE</div> <p>on the utility's own figures</p>                                                                    |
| Energy             | <b>Rural electrification</b>                          | <p><b>National access stood at 53% in July 2025</b> – 303,074 households on the grid and 840 on mini-grids of 569,631 in all.</p> <p>2025-07-01 – the energy compact records 303,074 households electrified through grid extension and 840 through mini-grids, of 569,631 households in total, leaving 47% without access, against a universal-access target for 2030.</p> <p>2025-08-04 – a grid extension launched to electrify four remote villages in Thaba-Tseka.</p> <p>2026-05-27 – a \$50m credit was approved for grid expansion in peri-urban, rural and highland areas with off-grid solar.</p> <p>The compact publishes a national rate and household counts; no separate rural rate is stated, so the gap between the settled lowlands and the highlands cannot be read from the repository.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | <div>MOVEMENT</div>                                                                                                         |
| Technical Capacity | <b>Robustness of government hardware and software</b> | <p>Government ICT was <b>assessed as fragmented with low cybersecurity preparedness in 2023</b>; no later assessment is held.</p> <p>Terms of reference were published for a project manager to lead the upgrade of the integrated financial management information system to a current platform version (terms of reference). A hiring notice is the earliest stage of a build.</p> <p>2023-03-06 – a project appraisal assessed government ICT as fragmented, with low cybersecurity preparedness.</p> <p>2026-02-26 – the 2026 work plan continues building the identity platform, the one part of the estate with funded work behind it.</p> <p>The assessment is three years old and nothing has re-tested it. No uptime figure, asset register or refresh cycle for government systems is published.</p> <p>2023-12-22 – the same project appraisal found a human resource management information system in place but little used beyond its payroll module, with personnel records largely on paper, and provided for payroll checks against the national identity system and digitisation of the records.</p> | <div>MOVEMENT</div>                                                                                                         |

| TOPIC              | INDICATOR                                                                | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | PROGRESS |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Technical Capacity | <b>Local capacity to maintain, manage and develop government systems</b> | <p>Government appointed its <a href="#">first chief information security officer</a> and announced a plan to move <a href="#">ICT services out of the civil service</a> into a separate agency.</p> <p>The first chief information security officer across government was reported appointed on 29 July 2026 (appointment, account).</p> <p>A separate government ICT agency was announced the same day, to take ICT services out of the civil service, with no enabling instrument, scope or date published (agency).</p> <p>Both are institutional rather than measured: the repository holds no count of technical staff in government, no maintenance arrangement and no assessment of what the state can run without a vendor.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | MOVEMENT |
| Cybersecurity      | <b>National cybersecurity readiness</b>                                  | <p>An <a href="#">interim national response team</a> launched in July 2026 and a <a href="#">security operations centre</a> is being stood up, against <a href="#">no national strategy</a> at the last review.</p> <p>LesComCSIRT launched in Maseru on 29 July 2026 and operates on an interim basis, ahead of the statute intended to establish it (launch, account).</p> <p>A national security operations centre was reported being stood up the same month, having been budgeted as a Government Security Operations Centre in the 2025/26 budget speech; no host, operator or date is published (centre, budget).</p> <p>A capacity maturity review of March 2023 rated the strategy dimension at start-up and confirmed no official national cybersecurity strategy, and none has been published since (review).</p> <p>2023-12 – a ransomware attack reached the central bank's primary and disaster-recovery sites, services took nine working days to restore, and the bank began setting up a round-the-clock security operations centre.</p> | MOVEMENT |

## DPI

| TOPIC         | INDICATOR                                 | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | PROGRESS |
|---------------|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Data Exchange | <b>National data exchange system</b>      | <p><a href="#">X-Road</a> was presented in February 2026 as one of three systems under development, with no go-live date published.</p> <p>The interoperability platform was presented at a joint ministry and university review of digital public infrastructure progress on 20 February 2026 (review).</p> <p>Once-only information exchange had been named a priority of the year in the memorandum with India signed in July 2025, with no platform then on record (memorandum). No go-live date, connected agency or transaction figure has been published.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | MOVEMENT |
| Data Exchange | <b>Use of digital id in other systems</b> | <p>The identity number is <a href="#">used for customer verification by banks, insurers and mobile operators</a>, and a cross-border use is proposed.</p> <p>2011-03-21 – the founding Act provides for third-party access to the register, the legal basis for other-system use.</p> <p>2025-11-17 – the financial sector strategy records the identity number in use by the credit bureau, banks, insurers and mobile network operators for customer verification.</p> <p>2026-02-26 – the 2026 work plan formalises cross-sector identity verification on the open-source platform.</p> <p>2026-04-22 – use of the identity card as a travel document at the South African border was proposed, with no agreement on the record.</p> <p>No count of systems consuming the identifier, and no authentication volume, is published.</p> <p>2024-01-30 – the electoral commission said a shared database with Home Affairs, begun earlier and dropped when the ministry withdrew, should be revived so that an identity number brings up a voter's record and deaths leave the roll. No agreement is on file.</p> | MOVEMENT |

| TOPIC                     | INDICATOR                                            | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | PROGRESS  |
|---------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Data Exchange             | <b>Interoperability of health systems</b>            | <p>A <a href="#">consultancy is integrating donor-project systems with the national DHIS2 platform</a>.</p> <p>2026-04-09 — the World Health Organization records the endorsed national digital health strategy and names digital transformation a priority.</p> <p>2026-04-01 — a workshop called for interoperability among the identity, civil registration, education and health databases.</p> <p>2026-06-19 — a consultancy was commissioned to integrate project systems with the national DHIS2 platform.</p> <p>Apart from the patient register's automatic feed into the district system, the integration on the record is of a donor project into the national platform. No health information exchange is held.</p> <p>2025-11 — the electronic patient register compiles facility-level data and sends it automatically into the district health information system.</p> | MOVEMENT  |
| Data Exchange             | <b>Interoperability of education systems</b>         | <p>The <a href="#">education management system is rolling out on the DHIS2 platform</a>, with a teacher system developed separately.</p> <p>2026-05-11 — the education management information system is rolling out on the DHIS2 platform, the same platform the health sector uses.</p> <p>2026-04-01 — a teacher management information system is being developed, informed by a peer exchange with Zambia, a <a href="#">workstream</a> distinct from the education system.</p> <p>Two education systems are being built on separate tracks and the repository holds nothing on their connecting to each other or to the identity layer.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | MOVEMENT  |
| Data Exchange             | <b>Interoperability of social protection systems</b> | <p><a href="#">Digital birth registration feeds the social registry</a>, with a district data refresh run from December 2025.</p> <p>2025-06-19 — digital birth registration under the child programme is integrated with the social registry, the repository's clearest evidence of two national registries exchanging data.</p> <p>2025-11-12 — a registry data-refresh exercise ran from December 2025 to March 2026.</p> <p>2026-02-26 — the identity work plan references alignment with the second national social protection strategy.</p> <p>No data-sharing agreement or technical specification for the linkage is published.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | MOVEMENT  |
| Digital Identity and CRVS | <b>Robustness of system</b>                          | <p>The <a href="#">National Identification System</a> is in operation, and the most recent account held of it is a case study published in 2022.</p> <p>The system is recorded as in operation, documented in a World Bank GovTech case study of 2022 and in the same institution's service-delivery study of that year (case study, service delivery).</p> <p>No later coverage, enrolment or performance figure is held, and the independent research on digital identity in the country dates from 2021 (research).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | NO CHANGE |

| TOPIC                     | INDICATOR                                                    | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | PROGRESS                                                            |
|---------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Digital Identity and CRVS | <b>Registration of entire population</b>                     | <p>The identity register <a href="#">covered roughly 85% of the eligible population in 2022</a>, and <a href="#">perceived ease of obtaining an identity document rose 42.5 points to 58.9</a> over 2014-2023.</p> <p>2022-05 — an assessment put coverage at an estimated 85 per cent of the eligible population, a little over a million people of a total 1.2 million.</p> <p>2026-02-26 — a 2026 commitment was made to an integrated digital identity system.</p> <p>2026-06-29 — a modernisation framework consultation opened at the home affairs ministry.</p> <p>The coverage figure is four years old and both movements since are about the platform rather than enrolment. No later count is published.</p> <p>2024 — public perception of how easy it is to obtain an identity document rose 42.5 points over 2014-2023 to 58.9 of 100, 15th of 54 African states and the country's most improved governance indicator. It measures perceived access, not enrolment.</p> | <div>MOVEMENT</div> <p>on perceived access rather than coverage</p> |
| Digital Identity and CRVS | <b>National maintenance of id and credentials systems</b>    | <p>A <a href="#">2026 work plan with UNICEF</a> commits to a MOSIP-based national identity platform covering passport and identity renewal and proof-of-life verification.</p> <p>The work plan was signed by the ministry and UNICEF on 3 March 2026, covering passport and identity renewal, biometric registration and proof-of-life verification on a MOSIP base (work plan).</p> <p>Digital identity pilots had begun under the memorandum with India, with no platform then named (memorandum), and the systems under development were reviewed with the national university in February 2026 (review). No procurement, vendor or go-live date is published.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | <div>MOVEMENT</div>                                                 |
| Digital Identity and CRVS | <b>Authentication</b>                                        | <p>A <a href="#">digital service-ID pilot</a> of about 10,000 participants began in April 2026, requiring a national identity document, a registered SIM and biometric registration.</p> <p>The pilot was announced on 25 March 2026 to begin on 2 April with about 10,000 participants in a testing phase (pilot).</p> <p>Registration requires a valid national identity document, a registered SIM card and biometric registration. No vendor, legal basis or evaluation criteria is stated, and no result from the pilot has been published.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | <div>MOVEMENT</div>                                                 |
| Digital Identity and CRVS | <b>Digital id from birth</b>                                 | <p>A <a href="#">unique personal identification number is issued on birth registration</a>, with a scale-up roadmap to 2030.</p> <p>2011-03-21 — the founding Act provides for a unique identity number at registration, including for children entered through a parent or guardian.</p> <p>2026-07-18 — the registry's own presentation states a unique personal identification number is issued on birth registration, with a nationwide scale-up roadmap running to 2030.</p> <p>2026-04-01 — a proposal was put to use maternal health records to trigger earlier birth registration.</p> <p>No birth-registration completeness figure is published, so how many children the number actually reaches cannot be stated.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | <div>MOVEMENT</div>                                                 |
| Digital Identity and CRVS | <b>Interoperability of birth registration and digital id</b> | <p>The registry runs an <a href="#">integrated civil registration and identity architecture</a>, now under a modernisation framework.</p> <p>2022-05 — an assessment documents the integrated civil registration and national identity architecture and the interoperability gaps left in it.</p> <p>2026-02-26 — the 2026 work plan frames civil registration and digital identity development together.</p> <p>2026-06-29 — a stakeholder consultation opened on a systems architecture and modernisation framework covering both.</p> <p>The architecture is integrated on paper and the gaps named in 2022 have not been reported closed.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | <div>MOVEMENT</div>                                                 |

| TOPIC                        | INDICATOR                       | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | PROGRESS  |
|------------------------------|---------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Digital Identity and CRVS    | Use by other systems            | <p>The identity number is <a href="#">in use for customer verification across the financial sector</a>, and cross-sector authentication is being formalised.</p> <p>2025-11-17 — the financial sector strategy is the most current statement of the identity number's linkage to the credit bureau, banks, insurers and mobile network operators.</p> <p>2026-02-26 — the 2026 work plan formalises cross-sector authentication and financial-services identity verification.</p> <p>2025-08-26 — a framework workshop set out identity-verified access to services, the earliest in-window statement of the design.</p> <p>What the repository does not hold is a transaction figure: how often the identity is actually checked, by whom, and at what cost to the relying party.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | MOVEMENT  |
| Digital Payments and Fintech | Governance role of central bank | <p>The central bank's <a href="#">national payment switch</a> has localised instant payments, ATM and point-of-sale transactions across four commercial banks.</p> <p>LeSwitch piloted its instant-payments stream in October 2022 and launched it on 20 March 2024, after the central bank commissioned the production environment in June 2023 and postponed go-live several times over participant testing, card issuing and security requirements. ATM localisation followed in October 2024 and point-of-sale localisation on 11 May 2025, across four commercial banks (point of sale, central bank).</p> <p>E-commerce and retail were named as the next steps and nothing later is held, so the switch's coverage is recorded as at May 2025.</p> <p>2023 — the central bank reported that the move of Lesotho Wire, the only large-value settlement system, to the ISO 20022 messaging standard had slipped to an October 2024 go-live after problems with third-party providers. No later account of the migration is held.</p>                                                                                                                            | NO CHANGE |
| Digital Payments and Fintech | G2P functionality               | <p>Child Grants Programme payments are <a href="#">moving from cash-in-transit to mobile network operators</a>, after <a href="#">pilots found cash 1.5 to 7 times costlier</a>; <a href="#">20,000 beneficiaries</a> had digital payments by April 2025.</p> <p>Digital grant payments to 20,000 beneficiaries of the Child Grants Programme were in operation when the digital birth registration programme launched in April 2025 (programme).</p> <p>No later enrolment figure, payment volume or extension to another transfer is held, and no other government payment stream is recorded as digital.</p> <p>2021 — a World Bank review found social grants still paid largely in cash, with the Child Grants Programme piloting M-Pesa and EcoCash in a few districts and evaluations putting cash delivery at 1.5 to 7 times the cost of mobile payment.</p> <p>2025-01 — the government was moving social assistance from cash-in-transit services to mobile payments through selected network operators, with EU, UNICEF and World Bank support, and acknowledged problems in the transition. Neither source states how many beneficiaries have moved.</p> | MOVEMENT  |
| Digital Payments and Fintech | Revenue collection              | <p><a href="#">Tax e-payment integration</a> went live in February 2026 for company tax, pay-as-you-earn, value-added tax and customs duties.</p> <p>Revenue Services Lesotho and Standard Lesotho Bank launched the integration on 11 February 2026, reachable over USSD, internet banking and the bank's mobile application (launch).</p> <p>No collection figure, share of receipts taken electronically, or extension to a second bank has been published since.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | MOVEMENT  |

| TOPIC                        | INDICATOR                             | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | PROGRESS                                                                                     |
|------------------------------|---------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Digital Payments and Fintech | <b>B2B and B2G functionality</b>      | <p>The <a href="#">national e-invoicing platform</a> is rolling out with <a href="#">business-to-business</a> and <a href="#">business-to-government</a> invoicing.</p> <p>2023-03-14 — the revenue authority launched its e-payment and e-taxation platform, the <a href="#">operative business-to-government</a> rail.</p> <p>2026-02-10 — a payment gateway with a commercial bank went live for tax settlement.</p> <p>2026-08-12 — the national e-invoicing platform is rolling out nationwide, carrying business-to-business and business-to-government invoicing.</p> <p>No transaction volume or value is published for any of the three.</p>                                                                                                                                                                      | MOVEMENT                                                                                     |
| Digital Payments and Fintech | <b>P2P, P2G and P2B functionality</b> | <p>A <a href="#">wallet investment service</a> launched in July 2026 over USSD, from M50 for individual customers and M300 for group-savings customers.</p> <p>Tsetela launched in Maseru on 22 July 2026 over a USSD short code, from M50 for individual mobile-money customers and M300 for group-savings customers, with the asset manager licensed by the Central Bank of Lesotho (launch, account).</p> <p>It is the first investment product reachable from a wallet on record (report), and no subscriber or value figure has been published since (coverage).</p> <p>The dominant operator launched an electronic top-up service that drops physical vouchers, with top-ups from M1.50. No uptake figure, agent-network effect or regulator position is held, and the minimum top-up is the only price stated.</p> | MOVEMENT                                                                                     |
| Digital Payments and Fintech | <b>Population uptake</b>              | <p>Mobile money was spun into a <a href="#">separately constituted entity</a> with <a href="#">14,000 agents</a>, while the second wallet has been <a href="#">unchanged since 2024</a>.</p> <p>The mobile money business was spun off into VCL Financial Services on 13 March 2026 (spin-off) and reported 14,000 agents by June 2026 (anniversary).</p> <p>EcoCash completed a platform migration in October 2024 with group savings, payroll and fraud detection integrated, and wallet interest payouts stated as forthcoming; nothing later is held (migration). No account or active-user figure is published for either.</p> <p>2023 — the regulator's household survey found 65.1% of individuals using mobile money, up from 43.2% in 2016 and 57.9% in 2019, with no split by provider.</p>                      | MOVEMENT                                                                                     |
| Digital Payments and Fintech | <b>Cross-border functionality</b>     | <p><a href="#">Renminbi settlement</a> became available through a commercial bank in July 2026, while <a href="#">migrant workers moved to fintechs</a> as South African rules tightened.</p> <p>Standard Bank extended access to China's cross-border interbank payment system beyond South Africa to five markets including Lesotho, reported on 27 July 2026 (access).</p> <p>Migrant workers remitting from South Africa moved from banks to fintechs as South African remittance and banking rules tightened, reported in June 2026 (remittances). No corridor volume, price or regional switch connection is published.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                          | MIXED<br>a new renminbi settlement route against migrant workers pushed out of bank channels |
| Digital Payments and Fintech | <b>Consumer protection</b>            | <p><a href="#">Three implementing regulations under the consumer protection Act</a> reached Senate adoption in May 2026.</p> <p>2022-06-03 — the Financial Consumer Protection Act establishes the regime and the central bank's powers under it.</p> <p>2026-05-07 — three implementing regulations reached Senate adoption, four years after the Act.</p> <p>2026-05-05 — the Payment System Bill would license fintech providers under one law.</p> <p>No complaints figure, redress statistic or dispute-resolution route for payment users is published.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | MOVEMENT                                                                                     |

| TOPIC      | INDICATOR                         | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | PROGRESS                                                                      |
|------------|-----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Registries | <b>Population register</b>        | <p>The <a href="#">National Identity Register is established by the 2011 Act</a>; the movement is a modernisation framework, not enrolment.</p> <p>2011-03-21 — section 3 of the Act establishes the register itself.</p> <p>2026-02-26 — the 2026 work plan ties open-source platform development to the register.</p> <p>2026-06-29 — a consultation opened on a systems architecture design and modernisation framework for the registry.</p> <p>No registered-population figure later than 2022, no deduplication rate and no register-quality measure is published.</p>                                                                                                                                                                              | <div>MOVEMENT</div> <p>on the platform rather than the register</p>           |
| Registries | <b>Civil register</b>             | <p><a href="#">Digital birth registration</a> has run since April 2025 with no enrolment figure, while the <a href="#">Ibrahim Index scored civil registration at 100.0, first of 54</a> for 2023.</p> <p>The programme launched on 2 April 2025 with the European Union and UNICEF (launch).</p> <p>No registration count, coverage share or link to the national identification system has been published since, so the repository records that the registration is digital and not how much of the population it reaches.</p> <p>2024 — the Ibrahim Index scored civil registration at 100.0 of 100 for 2023, first of 54 African states and 12.5 points above 2014. The score is a composite of expert assessments, not a count of registrations.</p> | <div>MOVEMENT</div> <p>on an index score rather than a registration count</p> |
| Registries | <b>Address register</b>           | <p><a href="#">No state address register exists; a private nationwide platform launched in May 2026.</a></p> <p>2011-02-24 — the land regulations carry the allocation and identification registers, the closest operative instrument to an address register.</p> <p>2026-05-08 — officials proposed a national spatial development infrastructure policy, stating that no spatial-data policy currently exists.</p> <p>2026-05-22 — a private nationwide digital-address platform launched, filling the gap the officials had described a fortnight earlier.</p> <p>The addressing layer a state usually owns is in private hands here, and the repository holds no arrangement governing that.</p>                                                      | <div>MIXED</div> <p>a private platform where the state has none</p>           |
| Registries | <b>Business register</b>          | <p><a href="#">A single window is in development at the one-stop business facilitation centre</a>, and registration fees were waived for small firms.</p> <p>2011-09-02 — the Companies Act establishes the Registrar of Companies and the incorporation regime.</p> <p>2025-11-20 — a competitiveness project confirms a business facilitation single window to simplify registration and licensing.</p> <p>2026-05-07 — the Senate backed a registration and licensing fee waiver for micro, small and medium enterprises, already yielding new registrations.</p> <p>No count of registered companies, and no processing time, is published.</p>                                                                                                       | <div>MOVEMENT</div>                                                           |
| Registries | <b>Social protection register</b> | <p><a href="#">NISSA</a> holds data on more than 90 per cent of households and has a child-centred redesign piloted in one district.</p> <p>The registry holds data on more than 90 per cent of households, categorised by vulnerability, and a child-centred redesign was piloted in Mafeteng District under the Universal DPI Safeguards Framework (redesign).</p> <p>The registry and its companion management information system were procured together in 2024 (procurement). No update to the coverage figure and no evaluation of the redesign is held.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                        | <div>MOVEMENT</div>                                                           |

| TOPIC                                   | INDICATOR                 | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | PROGRESS |
|-----------------------------------------|---------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Registries                              | <b>Electoral register</b> | <p>A <a href="#">voter registration strategy</a> was formally endorsed in June 2026, with constituency readiness assessments under way.</p> <p>2013 — the electoral commission's report describes the constitutional mandate for the general register of electors and the 2011 electoral Act.</p> <p>2026-06-15 — constituency readiness assessments began ahead of registration intensification, with a commissioner deployment framework covering register audits.</p> <p>2026-06-25 — the commission, government and international partners formally endorsed the voter registration strategy.</p> <p>2026-06-04 — a Bill before the Senate would tie registration and verification to the national identity number.</p> <p>No registered-elector count is published.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | MOVEMENT |
| Registries                              | <b>Tax register</b>       | <p>The taxpayer register is now fed by <a href="#">mandatory structured electronic transaction data</a>.</p> <p>2001 — section 7(1) of the Revenue Authority Act authorises systems for taxpayer identification.</p> <p>2026-03-27 — the e-invoicing regulations legally establish structured electronic transaction data in taxpayer records.</p> <p>2026-02-10 — a bank payment gateway with automatic reconciliation went live.</p> <p>No registered-taxpayer count is published.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | MOVEMENT |
| Registries                              | <b>Land register</b>      | <p>The land authority is <a href="#">taking register services into the districts</a>, with new offices planned.</p> <p>2010-06-15 — the Land Administration Authority Act charges the authority with maintaining a complete land-holding database.</p> <p>2025-08-05 — district outreach expanded access to register services, with new district offices planned.</p> <p>2025-08-27 — the authority put its 2026-2029 strategic plan out to tender, prioritising technology adoption for registration services.</p> <p>No parcel count, coverage figure or registration time is published.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | MOVEMENT |
| Sectoral management information systems | <b>Health</b>             | <p>An <a href="#">electronic patient register, piloted at six facilities in 2018, is planned for 178 government facilities nationwide</a>, and a <a href="#">monitoring and evaluation consultancy</a> was advertised in August 2026.</p> <p>The tender was advertised on 16 August 2026 (advertisement). It is a tender rather than an award, and no value, duration or reporting system is named.</p> <p>2018 — the health ministry piloted a client-level electronic register at four health centres and two hospitals, the first stage of a planned rollout across 178 government facilities, after a hospital records system introduced in 16 hospitals in 2013 fell short.</p> <p>2025-05-12 — a survey of 71 health workers at a district hospital and 16 clinics in Mafeteng found 87% rating the system useful, with network and power outages interrupting its use.</p> <p>2025-11 — the register covers five programmes, among them tuberculosis, antenatal care and cervical cancer, and paper recording is to end only when it runs nationwide. No count of facilities live on it is published.</p> | MOVEMENT |
| Sectoral management information systems | <b>Education</b>          | <p>A <a href="#">foundational literacy and numeracy dashboard</a> is under construction for Grades 1 to 3, with tablets for principals in 300 project schools.</p> <p>UNICEF and the Global Partnership for Education announced support on 23 July 2026 for the dashboard, covering Grades 1 to 3, with tablets for principals in 300 project schools and solar power in 25 cluster learning spaces (support).</p> <p>No go-live date, data source or coverage beyond the project schools is published, and no wider education management information system is held for the country.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | MOVEMENT |

| TOPIC                                   | INDICATOR                | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | PROGRESS                                          |
|-----------------------------------------|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| Sectoral management information systems | <b>Social protection</b> | <p>The <a href="#">MISSA social-assistance management information system</a> was put to tender in 2024, and no award or delivery is on record.</p> <p>The request for proposals closed on 12 August 2024, and nothing since records an award, a contract or a delivery (procurement). An earlier management information system was built between November 2014 and January 2016, so the country has had one and does not now have a recorded successor.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | <b>STALLED</b>                                    |
| Sectoral management information systems | <b>Justice</b>           | <p>The <a href="#">needs assessment for an automated case management system</a> was still in progress in 2023; nothing later is held.</p> <p>2023-02-01 — the Chief Justice reported the needs assessment for an automated case management system still in progress, the latest statement the repository holds.</p> <p>2026-04-20 — a crime-reporting platform launched nationally, with a police digital transformation policy and strategy alongside it, the clearest movement in the police-to-justice chain.</p> <p>2026-05-18 — the law and justice ministry hosted a regional conference on digital transformation of intellectual property offices. The courts themselves have no case management system on the record, and the reporting end of the chain has moved while the adjudicating end has not.</p>                                                                 | <b>NO CHANGE</b><br>an assessment three years old |
| Sectoral management information systems | <b>Tax</b>               | <p>The <a href="#">e-taxation platform gained bank payment integration and mandatory electronic invoicing</a> inside the window.</p> <p>2025-02-06 — the revenue authority published its operational guide to the e-taxation platform, the tax-sector system itself.</p> <p>2026-02-10 — a payment gateway with a commercial bank went live with automatic reconciliation.</p> <p>2026-03-27 — electronic invoicing was made mandatory, putting structured transaction data into the system.</p> <p>No filing rate or system availability is published.</p> <p>2025-04-01 — the revenue authority reported integrations with five institutions for payment collection, registration checks and automated PAYE compliance, two more near completion, online tax clearance certificates issued automatically in near real time, and M9.74bn remitted in 2024/25, 3% above target.</p> | <b>MOVEMENT</b>                                   |
| Sectoral management information systems | <b>Customs</b>           | <p><a href="#">ASYCUDAWorld</a> has run at all commercial borders since 2015/16; a smart one-stop border post is now in build.</p> <p>2016-07-27 — the customs system was piloted in 2014/15 and reached all commercial borders in 2015/16.</p> <p>2026-03-30 — a project supervision report covers the customs and trade facilitation component and the smart one-stop border post.</p> <p>2026-05-13 — a mission reviewed customs administration and border post progress.</p> <p>No clearance time, declaration volume or revenue figure is published.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | <b>MOVEMENT</b>                                   |
| Sectoral management information systems | <b>Land</b>              | <p>The land authority runs an <a href="#">integrated geographic information system</a>, now reaching into the districts.</p> <p>2021-11-10 — the authority's geographic information system, built to manage all land records, was recognised by a regional award.</p> <p>2025-08-05 — district outreach carried register services closer to communities.</p> <p>2026-05-08 — officials proposed a national spatial data policy, stating none currently exists, which is the policy layer the land system has been running without.</p> <p>No performance or coverage figure for the system is published.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | <b>MOVEMENT</b>                                   |

| TOPIC                   | INDICATOR                    | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | PROGRESS |
|-------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Other GovTech and e-Gov | <b>e-government services</b> | <p>An <a href="#">e-Parliament system</a> was completed, a <a href="#">digital outreach studio</a> opened, and a <a href="#">decision support system</a> is under development.</p> <p>The 2025/26 budget speech reported the e-Parliament system implemented, described as a milestone in modernising legislative processes, with no further detail published (budget speech).</p> <p>A Digital Outreach Studio was launched in June 2026 under the second phase of the eGovernment Infrastructure Project (studio).</p> <p>A decision support system for planning and budgeting was presented as under development in February 2026, with no scope, host or date published (review).</p> <p>2023 — the regulator's household survey found 6.7% of individuals interacting with government services online, against a 40% target for that year under the ITU Connect 2030 agenda. It is the first such figure held.</p> | MOVEMENT |

## Digitalisation

| TOPIC                                     | INDICATOR                                         | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | PROGRESS |
|-------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Digitalisation of sub-national government | <b>ICT infrastructure for local government</b>    | <p><a href="#">Digital ambassadors have been deployed across local councils</a> for internet access and computer-literacy training.</p> <p>2018-01-04 — the ministry connected its first community council, with a stated plan to reach all of them.</p> <p>2025-11-05 — a social registry update ran across five community councils in Leribe.</p> <p>2026-04-01 — digital ambassadors were reported deployed across local councils for internet access and computer-literacy training.</p> <p>Eight years after the plan to connect every council, the repository holds no count of how many are connected.</p>                                                                               | MOVEMENT |
| Digitalisation of sub-national government | <b>Digitalisation of local government records</b> | <p>A <a href="#">construction permit system</a> is live at the capital's city council, taking applications, documents, staged review and permit issue online.</p> <p>The Maseru City Council construction permit automation system is live, providing online application, document upload, staged review, message and email notifications, auto-generated invoices and digital permit issue (system).</p> <p>It was built by a Lesotho firm with a Kenyan partner under World Bank private-sector competitiveness funding. No permit volume, processing time or extension to a second council is published.</p>                                                                                 | MOVEMENT |
| Rural digital data capture                | <b>Digitalisation of rural health clinics</b>     | <p>A <a href="#">trial across 103 rural villages found village health workers on mobile decision support outperformed facility referral</a>.</p> <p>2026-04-09 — the World Health Organization names DHIS2 and digital transformation among health priorities, the most current status statement held.</p> <p>2026-02-12 — a cluster-randomised trial across 103 rural villages found community health workers using mobile decision support outperformed facility referral for hypertension care.</p> <p>The evidence here is outcome evidence, which is rare in this frame; what it does not establish is how many clinics run any digital system, a figure the repository does not hold.</p> | MOVEMENT |
| Rural digital data capture                | <b>Digitalisation of rural primary schools</b>    | <p>A <a href="#">school and clinic connectivity programme</a> opened at a Butha-Buthe school in January 2026, after community hotspots in three rural places.</p> <p>T-Connect Impact launched at Soofia International School in Butha-Buthe on 17 January 2026 (launch).</p> <p>It followed the first community hotspots handed over at Matsieng, Thaba Bosiu and Mokhotlong in September 2025 (hotspots). No count of connected schools is published, no clinic is named, and no national programme for rural school connectivity is held.</p>                                                                                                                                                | MOVEMENT |

| TOPIC                      | INDICATOR                                       | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | PROGRESS |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Rural digital data capture | <b>Digitalisation of rural registry offices</b> | <p><a href="#">Thirty SMS-based birth registration stations were established across three districts</a> in August 2026.</p> <p>A national farmers portal was launched, placing every farmer in a single digital registry (launch). No enrolment figure is stated.</p> <p>2022-05 — an assessment sets out the registry's use cases and coverage.</p> <p>2026-08-05 — thirty birth registration stations were established in government and church health facilities across Maseru, Berea and Leribe, on a low-technology SMS platform.</p> <p>2026-02-26 — the 2026 work plan continues the identity infrastructure behind them.</p> <p>The capture point chosen is the health facility rather than the registry office, and the platform is SMS rather than a terminal. No count of registry offices with a digital system is published.</p> <p>2025-09 — the civil registry's Qacha's Nek manager said birth, marriage, identity and death services devolved to councils fail without transport to carry applications, and a January 2026 outreach served more than 100 people in remote villages. No digital capture at council level is on file.</p> | MOVEMENT |
| Rural digital data capture | <b>Digitalisation of rural police stations</b>  | <p>A <a href="#">crime-reporting platform launched nationally in April 2026</a>, with station equipment and connectivity following.</p> <p>2026-04-20 — the crime-reporting platform, in development since 2019, launched nationally alongside a police digital transformation policy and strategy.</p> <p>2026-06-12 — twenty desktop computers were handed to the police service for selected stations.</p> <p>2026-07-31 — the universal service fund opened procurement for Wi-Fi and network equipment at police stations across all ten districts.</p> <p>The reporting app reached the public before the stations received computers or connectivity, and the repository holds no count of stations with either.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | MOVEMENT |

## Technology

| TOPIC | INDICATOR                                     | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | PROGRESS                              |
|-------|-----------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| AI    | <b>Use of AI in government administration</b> | <p>The <a href="#">AI Policy of 2025 is the stated foundation</a>; the one named tool is a planned chatbot for farmers.</p> <p>2025-10-30 — the ministry's principal secretary described a planned government chatbot for farmers, with an implementation plan for 2026.</p> <p>2026-06-11 — digital policies were signed at a ceremony that also confirmed the innovation studio operational.</p> <p>2026-07-07 — the government told the UN global dialogue that the 2025 policy is its AI governance foundation.</p> <p>No AI system is described as running in government administration. The repository holds a policy, a plan and a pilot.</p> <p>2025-04-01 — the revenue authority reported completing the purchase of a customer relationship management system it describes as AI-based, meant to unify client correspondence and measure service across channels. No go-live is reported.</p> | MOVEMENT<br>at policy and pilot stage |

| TOPIC                | INDICATOR                                            | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | PROGRESS                                   |
|----------------------|------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| AI                   | Use of AI in sectoral management information systems | <p><a href="#">Computer-aided screening is in use in tuberculosis case-finding</a>, the one production system the repository holds.</p> <p>2025-06-04 — a peer-reviewed study confirms computer-aided chest X-ray screening operating in tuberculosis case-finding.</p> <p>2026-05-11 — the agricultural research department was validating content for an extension chatbot ahead of a pilot.</p> <p>2025-12-12 — an academic proposal was published for a Lesotho-specific health diagnostic model.</p> <p>The screening tool is a donor-supplied clinical device rather than a component of a national system; no sectoral management information system is described as using AI.</p>                                                                                             | MOVEMENT                                   |
| AI                   | Development of national / regional AI systems        | <p><a href="#">A Sesotho word bank is being compiled to train locally relevant AI systems</a>.</p> <p>2025-01-21 — a 73-page draft implementation plan sits behind the AI policy; the plan itself is not published.</p> <p>2026-02-18 — the ministry, a development agency and the national university are compiling a Sesotho word bank to train locally relevant AI systems.</p> <p>A language resource is the foundation a small-language country needs before anything else can be built locally. No model, dataset licence or compute arrangement is on the record.</p> <p>2026-09-23 — the prime minister told a UN meeting that planning was complete and Phase One of a National Compute Roadmap to 2029 had begun; the roadmap is not published.</p>                         | MOVEMENT                                   |
| AI                   | Control of AI abuse                                  | <p><a href="#">The Data Protection Act is the strongest legal safeguard reaching AI-processed personal data</a>; the cyber law is still a Bill.</p> <p>2025-08-31 — a government press statement warned the public about AI-generated deepfakes impersonating the King and the Prime Minister, naming the absent cyber law as the enforcement gap.</p> <p>2026-01-13 — a meeting between the ministry and the regulator linked AI-enabled cyber threats to the stalled Cybersecurity Bill.</p> <p>2012-02-22 — the Data Protection Act is the binding statute reaching AI-processed personal data.</p> <p>The head of state has been impersonated and the government said in its own statement that it lacked the law to act. That Bill was still awaiting approval a year later.</p> | MOVEMENT<br>on warnings rather than powers |
| ICT Industry         | National capacity in DT-related production           | <p>A Lesotho firm built the capital's <a href="#">permit system</a> with a Kenyan partner, and two local firms hosted an <a href="#">executive cloud and security workshop</a>.</p> <p>Computer Business Solutions of Lesotho built the Maseru City Council permit system with Web Masters of Kenya under World Bank funding (system).</p> <p>The same firm and DNS Technologies hosted an executive workshop in Maseru on 30 May 2026 on ransomware, cloud security, data sovereignty and immutable backup (workshop). Those are the only two records of domestic technology production or service capability in the repository.</p>                                                                                                                                                 | MOVEMENT                                   |
| Innovation ecosystem | Technology hubs                                      | <p>The <a href="#">innovation studio is operational with a second under way</a>, alongside two incubation programmes.</p> <p>2026-06-11 — the studio at the polytechnic was confirmed operational and ground was broken for a second.</p> <p>2026-03-20 — an entrepreneurship hub opened its fifth incubation cycle with sixty enterprises selected.</p> <p>2025-10-29 — the first software factory cohort graduated, eight in number.</p> <p>Three hubs are running and none publishes a survival, funding or employment figure for what leaves them.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | MOVEMENT                                   |

| TOPIC                | INDICATOR                     | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | PROGRESS |
|----------------------|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Innovation ecosystem | <b>Tech startup ecosystem</b> | <p>A <a href="#">UNDP and Econet memorandum</a> was renewed in July 2026 across three pillars, one of them small-business digital entrepreneurship.</p> <p>The memorandum was signed at Maseru on 28 July 2026, renewing a partnership first signed in 2020 and amended in 2022 (signing, account).</p> <p>Its three pillars are digital transformation, connectivity and artificial intelligence; support for innovation; and digital entrepreneurship among micro, small and medium enterprises. No amount, term or deliverable is stated, and no count of new firms or of firms reached is held.</p> <p>2025 — Lesotho was placed 132nd of 139 economies in the Global Innovation Index, 118th on innovation inputs and 139th on outputs, with business sophistication its weakest pillar at 137th. No earlier rank is published, so the level is recorded and the direction is not.</p> | MOVEMENT |

## Capacity

| TOPIC               | INDICATOR                                                  | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | PROGRESS |
|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Literacy            | <b>Digital literacy (civil service)</b>                    | <p>Ministry-level platform training and a <a href="#">geospatial application course for roads engineers</a> ran on top of the standing course list.</p> <p>2025-02-19 — the public service ministry lists its courses for public-sector digital skills.</p> <p>2025-11-06 — a service-delivery project funded capacity building for digital administrative platforms across key ministries.</p> <p>2026-04-22 — roads directorate engineers and technicians were trained on project management and an offline-capable geospatial mobile application.</p> <p>No civil servants trained, pass rate or coverage of the establishment is published.</p>                                               | MOVEMENT |
| Literacy            | <b>Digital literacy (general population)</b>               | <p>Government <a href="#">digital-literacy training</a> was reported running across all ten districts in July 2026, with no participant numbers published.</p> <p>The training was reported running in every district on 29 July 2026 (forum, account).</p> <p>No participant count, curriculum, duration or completion figure has been published (report), so the repository records national reach and no measure of what it delivers.</p> <p>2023 — the regulator's household survey found 35.1% of individuals with ICT skills, 19.4% basic and 15.7% above basic, against 58.4% using the internet. No earlier skills figure is held, so the level is recorded and the direction is not.</p> | MOVEMENT |
| Training and skills | <b>DT-related training in secondary education</b>          | <p><a href="#">AI literacy content entered the digital skills learning labs</a>, several of whose ambassadors are teachers.</p> <p>2024-12-30 — the National Digital Policy is the standing statement on digital-skills frameworks for schools.</p> <p>2025-11-13 — an education improvement project opened procurement for 500 laptops with mandatory ICT-skills training attached.</p> <p>2026-03-30 — AI literacy content reached the digital skills learning labs and digital ambassadors, several of them teachers.</p> <p>The training on the record reaches teachers and labs rather than a secondary curriculum, and no curriculum change is held.</p>                                    | MOVEMENT |
| Training and skills | <b>DT-related university facilities and qualifications</b> | <p>A <a href="#">National AI Academy</a> is proposed in a signed memorandum, with no timetable, governance, curriculum or host institution named.</p> <p>The academy was named in the memorandum signed by UNDP and Econet on 28 July 2026 (memorandum, signing).</p> <p>No timetable, governance structure, curriculum or host institution is named, and the repository holds no existing university department, qualification or facility in these subjects for the country.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                | MOVEMENT |

| TOPIC                 | INDICATOR                                                             | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | PROGRESS                                                                                                                                   |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Training and skills   | <b>Graduates entering DT ecosystem</b>                                | <p>An <a href="#">AI skills programme</a> began in June 2026, reported as the country's first, while a <a href="#">corporate training pledge</a> has delivered nothing in twelve months.</p> <p>The AI Skills Development Programme launched with the United States Embassy under the Sebatatso initiative on 17 June 2026, reported as the country's first digital-entrepreneurship and artificial-intelligence tools training (programme).</p> <p>Digital-skills training pledged by a mobile group and a cloud provider at the group chief executive's visit in August 2025 has nothing on record delivered in the twelve months since (pledge). No participant, completion or placement figure is published for either.</p> | <div>MIXED</div> <p>a first artificial-intelligence skills programme running against a corporate training pledge undelivered a year on</p> |
| Research institutions | <b>Think tanks and academic departments contributing to DT policy</b> | <p>One <a href="#">joint review of digital public infrastructure</a> with the national university's mathematics and computer science department is the whole of the record.</p> <p>The ministry and the National University of Lesotho reviewed digital public infrastructure progress together on 20 February 2026 (review).</p> <p>No research programme, funding, publication or output has followed it into the repository, and no other academic body or think tank is recorded contributing to digital policy.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                        | <div>NO CHANGE</div>                                                                                                                       |

## Inclusion

| TOPIC              | INDICATOR                              | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | PROGRESS                                                                    |
|--------------------|----------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Access to services | <b>Citizen feedback portals</b>        | <p>The <a href="#">crime-reporting app launched as a zero-rated feedback channel</a>, alongside the standing <a href="#">contact centre</a>.</p> <p>2022-05-17 – the National Contact Centre opened as the citizen feedback mechanism.</p> <p>2025-10-24 – the Ombudsman opened procurement for an electronic case management system to replace manual complaint recording.</p> <p>2026-04-20 – the crime and violence reporting app launched nationally as a zero-rated channel.</p> <p>None of the three publishes a volume, response time or resolution figure.</p>                                                                                                                                                    | <div>MOVEMENT</div>                                                         |
| Access to services | <b>Citizen participation in policy</b> | <p>A <a href="#">public survey of digital services experience</a> opened in August 2026 covering access, usability, trust and skills gaps.</p> <p>The survey opened on 9 August 2026, run by the ministry with the United Nations development programme as part of a donor-backed digital readiness assessment, and covers online applications, digital payments and health and education platforms (survey).</p> <p>No closing date, sample target or commitment to publish the results is stated, so the repository records that citizens were asked and not that the answers will be seen.</p>                                                                                                                         | <div>MOVEMENT</div>                                                         |
| Access to services | <b>Gender equity</b>                   | <p>A <a href="#">dedicated women in digital forum was held in April 2026</a>, and <a href="#">internet use differed by 5.1 points between men and women in 2023</a>.</p> <p>2024-12-30 – the National Digital Policy is the overarching statement.</p> <p>2025-11-20 – the minister described a community inclusion model whose digital ambassador approach targets women.</p> <p>2026-04-20 – a dedicated women in digital forum ran on the Commonwealth digital roadshow.</p> <p>No sex-disaggregated figure for digital skills is held.</p> <p>2023 – the regulator's household survey found internet use of 59.9% among men and 54.8% among women, a 5.1-point gap, with mobile phone ownership 0.6 points apart.</p> | <div>MOVEMENT</div> <p>with a small measured gender gap in internet use</p> |

| TOPIC              | INDICATOR                                     | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | PROGRESS  |
|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Access to services | <b>Inclusion of persons with disabilities</b> | <p>An <a href="#">accessible digital library and insight centre was announced in March 2026</a>, under a statute in force since 2021.</p> <p>2021-03-12 — the Persons with Disability Equity Act establishes the advisory council and accessible-communication duties.</p> <p>2025-10-15 — the UN resident coordinator called for accessible technology investment at the country's first disability accessibility conference.</p> <p>2026-03-16 — a memorandum with the incumbent operator announced a 4G-enabled digital library and insight centre carrying assistive technologies.</p> <p>Five years after the Act, the repository holds no accessibility standard for public digital services and no compliance assessment against the statute's communication duties.</p>                                                                                                                                                       | MOVEMENT  |
| Access to services | <b>Inclusion of refugees and IDPs</b>         | <p><a href="#">Biometric registration for refugees has run since 2018</a> on a separate system, with no stated pathway into the mainstream one.</p> <p>2018-10-11 — a biometric registration system for refugees and forcibly displaced people was handed to government.</p> <p>2026-02-26 — the 2026 identity work plan advances the mainstream platform and states no refugee or displaced-person inclusion pathway.</p> <p>Two identity systems run in parallel and the newer one is being built without a route from the older. No count of registered refugees is published.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | NO CHANGE |
| Digital divides    | <b>Bridging of digital divides</b>            | <p><a href="#">245 of more than 1,800 mapped schools are connected</a>, and the community inclusion model passed to the universal service fund.</p> <p>2025-11-19 — a ministerial statement reports 245 of more than 1,800 mapped schools connected under the schools connectivity programme, alongside universal-fund community digital centres.</p> <p>2025-11-20 — the community digital inclusion model moved from a development-agency pilot to full universal service fund management.</p> <p>2026-07-01 — the regulator's three-year plan makes universal and meaningful connectivity its top theme.</p> <p>The ministry put broadband coverage at 100% against about 50% regular internet use, so the divide these programmes address is one of use rather than reach.</p> <p>2023 — the regulator's household survey put urban internet use about 34 percentage points above rural, a gap more than double that of 2016.</p> | MOVEMENT  |

## Data

| TOPIC               | INDICATOR                                              | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | PROGRESS |
|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| National statistics | <b>National strategy for development of statistics</b> | <p>The <a href="#">strategy covering 2022/23 to 2026/27 is in force</a> and was <a href="#">peer-reviewed for the first time</a>.</p> <p>2026-08-29 — the Bureau of Statistics lists the strategy for 2022/23 to 2026/27 alongside the 2001 Act as its current framework.</p> <p>2025-12-12 — the first independent peer review of the national statistical system assessed the strategy and recommended legal and coordination reforms, the fourth Statistics Bill among them.</p> <p>2026-02-27 — an EU-funded initiative launched to strengthen the Bureau's institutional framework and system coordination.</p> <p>The strategy runs out in 2026/27 and no successor is on the record.</p> | MOVEMENT |

| TOPIC                 | INDICATOR                                  | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | PROGRESS  |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| National statistics   | <b>Censuses and surveys</b>                | <p>The <a href="#">seventh census has finished enumeration with mop-up still running in Maseru</a> and is in analysis; the 2016 round is still the last with published results.</p> <p>2018 — the 2016 census summary is the most recent completed round with published results.</p> <p>2026-03-13 — 2,750 tablets and 1,045 power banks were delivered for the first fully digital census.</p> <p>2026-06-05 — nationwide enumeration for the seventh census was completed and moved to analysis.</p> <p>Ten years separate the last published census from the one now in analysis, and no publication date for the new results is on the record.</p> <p>2026-09 — a second phase of the financial access points census was tendered to update the 2018 baseline of 5,597 geo-referenced points; no budget or completion date is given.</p> <p>2026-09-17 — mop-up operations were still running in Maseru, and the round is the first to ask questions recognising gender identity and sexuality, after the statistics bureau brought an advocacy organisation into the first census consultation. Advocates welcomed the inclusion while warning that the answers need explicit privacy and confidentiality safeguards. Results are to be published after review.</p> | MOVEMENT  |
| National statistics   | <b>Statistics from administrative data</b> | <p>Vital statistics are <a href="#">produced from civil registration records</a>; the peer review <a href="#">flagged integration gaps</a>.</p> <p>2024 — the fourth vital statistics report was produced from home affairs civil-registration records for the 2022 reference year.</p> <p>2025-12-12 — the peer review confirms administrative data in use across health, education and civil registration, and flags integration gaps and legal constraints.</p> <p>2026-02-26 — the 2026 work plan strengthens the identity and civil-registration infrastructure underneath.</p> <p>The legal constraints the review names are the same ones the fourth Statistics Bill is meant to lift, and that Bill is not yet enacted.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | MOVEMENT  |
| Open data             | <b>Use of open data</b>                    | <p>A 2021 assessment found <a href="#">no active government open-data programme</a> and no portal, and nothing since records one.</p> <p>The capacity assessment of September 2021 found no government open-data activity (assessment).</p> <p>A civil-society open data initiative launched in 2019, and the country ranked 151st of 187 in the 2020 Open Data Inventory. No government portal, dataset catalogue or publication commitment has appeared in the repository in the five years since.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | NO CHANGE |
| Use of satellite data | <b>Agricultural use of satellite data</b>  | <p>A <a href="#">public land cover dashboard launched in March 2026</a>, built on the operational national mapping system.</p> <p>2022-07-08 — an operational satellite land-cover and cropland mapping system was built for the catchment programme and official statistics.</p> <p>2026-03-02 — a public-facing land cover dashboard launched, naming farmers among its intended users.</p> <p>2026-06-25 — the June food security outlook draws on satellite rainfall and remote-sensing indicators for crop-condition and drought assessment.</p> <p>No figure for use of the dashboard, or for advisory services reaching farmers from it, is published.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | MOVEMENT  |

| TOPIC                 | INDICATOR                                   | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | PROGRESS |
|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Use of satellite data | <b>Meteorological use of satellite data</b> | <p>A <a href="#">nowcasting system integrating satellite data with observations was set up in 2026</a>, over a network described as fragmented.</p> <p>2011-07-19 — regional forecasting arrangements put satellite products into the cascading framework the national service works within.</p> <p>2025-09-29 — technical assistance opened to modernise a meteorological network of more than ninety stations and the multi-hazard early-warning systems on it.</p> <p>2026-04-08 — a nowcasting system integrating satellite data with observations and model output was set up, with a capacity-building phase from January to May 2026.</p> <p>The satellite layer is arriving over a ground network its own funders describe as fragmented.</p> | MOVEMENT |

## Geopolitics

| TOPIC                       | INDICATOR                                                  | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | PROGRESS  |
|-----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| US / hyperscaler activities | <b>USA / hyperscaler MoUs, engagements and commitments</b> | <p>The United States Embassy states <a href="#">US\$7.3bn of commercial partnerships</a> facilitated over eighteen months, of which the data-centre project is the largest.</p> <p>The embassy's own figure, carried as such, is US\$7.3bn of commercial partnerships facilitated in the country over the previous eighteen months, with Kobong the largest of them (statement).</p> <p>The embassy also launched an artificial-intelligence skills programme under the Sebatatso initiative in June 2026 (programme). No hyperscaler commitment, data-centre region or cloud agreement with a United States provider is recorded.</p>                                                                          | MOVEMENT  |
| China activities            | <b>Chinese MoUs, engagements and commitments</b>           | <p>Chinese engagement on file is a single financial route: <a href="#">renminbi settlement</a> reaching the country through a commercial bank in July 2026.</p> <p>Standard Bank extended access to China's cross-border interbank payment system beyond South Africa to five markets including Lesotho, reported on 27 July 2026 (access).</p> <p>No Chinese vendor contract, memorandum, loan or infrastructure project is recorded for the country in this repository, which makes the payment route the whole of the relationship on record.</p>                                                                                                                                                            | MOVEMENT  |
| EU activities               | <b>EU MoUs, engagements and commitments</b>                | <p>European engagement on file is the <a href="#">digital birth registration programme</a> run with the European Union and UNICEF since April 2025.</p> <p>The programme launched on 2 April 2025 with the European Union and UNICEF as partners (launch).</p> <p>No value, term or wider European digital engagement is recorded, and no European Union instrument covering the country's digital transformation is held.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | NO CHANGE |
| Gulf/UAE activities         | <b>Gulf MoUs, engagements and commitments</b>              | <p>Labour arrangements are <a href="#">concluded with Qatar, before cabinet for the Emirates and at an advanced stage with Saudi Arabia</a>.</p> <p>2026-02-05 — the Saudi ambassador reaffirmed an airport rehabilitation commitment while presenting credentials.</p> <p>2026-05-27 — the minister separated concluded, cabinet-pending and advanced-stage bilateral labour arrangements across the Gulf states.</p> <p>2026-06-05 — Lesotho pitched data-centre and multi-sector investment to Dubai Chambers, arguing from its water resources for cooling.</p> <p>The engagements on record are labour export and an investment pitch; no signed digital or data instrument with a Gulf state is held.</p> | MOVEMENT  |

| TOPIC               | INDICATOR                                      | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | PROGRESS    |
|---------------------|------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| India activities    | <b>India MoUs, engagements and commitments</b> | <p>The <a href="#">memorandum with India</a> of July 2025 named digital identity, a unified payment environment and once-only exchange as priorities, and nothing under it is on record.</p> <p>The memorandum was signed during the Indian minister of state's visit to Maseru on 29 July 2025, naming those three priorities for the year (memorandum).</p> <p>No deliverable, workstream or funding under it is on record a year later, though both the identity and the interoperability workstreams recorded elsewhere in this ledger cite it as their starting point.</p> | NO CHANGE   |
| Digital sovereignty | <b>Digital sovereignty</b>                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | NO EVIDENCE |

## Where the record is thin

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                              | WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | LAST PROBED    |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| <b>National Cybersecurity Strategy</b>                                            | The text of the strategy the minister invoked at the LesComCSIRT launch, or an official statement of its adoption date, version and targets. The 2022 Cybersecurity Capacity Maturity Model review states Lesotho had no official national strategy. | not yet probed |
| <b>National open data portal</b>                                                  | A government open-data portal or published open-data policy for Lesotho, or an official statement that none exists.                                                                                                                                  | 2026-08-31     |
| <b>AI legislation or regulations</b>                                              | an AI Act, or regulations made under an existing statute, with a gazette reference                                                                                                                                                                   | 2026-08-31     |
| <b>National address register</b>                                                  | a state address register or addressing standard with a coverage figure, or a ministerial statement that the private platform is the national one                                                                                                     | 2026-08-31     |
| <b>2025/26 outturn against the digital appropriations</b>                         | The 2025/26 actuals column of the 2027/28 estimates book or the audited 2025/26 accounts, read into the budget extract; only the provisional fourth-quarter bulletin is held.                                                                        | 2026-09-25     |
| <b>Universal Service Fund contribution rate and income</b>                        | The Communications Act 2012 section 33 contribution rules or LCA regulations setting the licensee levy, and the fund's audited income.                                                                                                               | 2026-09-25     |
| <b>Signed Data Management Policy text on hosting and cross-border transfer</b>    | Publication of the Data Management Policy signed in June 2026.                                                                                                                                                                                       | 2026-09-25     |
| <b>Source code, operating skills and exit for the Epicor-based IFMIS</b>          | The Epicor licence and support contract or a finance ministry statement on ownership and exit terms.                                                                                                                                                 | 2026-09-25     |
| <b>Data jurisdiction, portability and exit terms of the Kobong AI data centre</b> | Publication of the Convalt Energy memorandum of agreement or the implementation agreements due after the feasibility study.                                                                                                                          | 2026-09-25     |

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## ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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|-----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
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